

THE BRITISH CONQUEST OF BENGAL (PLASSEY 1757, BUXAR 1764, DUAL GOVERNMENT)

BENGAL BEFORE 1756: SUCCESSOR → CALCUTTA CRISIS AND THE → PLASSEY'S HIDDEN BATTLE: CONSPIRACY → PLASSEY AND THE MIR → MIR QASIM: REFORM, EQUALITY → BUXAR: COALITION BREADTH VERSUS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 BENGAL BEFORE 1756: SUCCESSOR STATE AND SOVEREIGNTY CONFLICT

BENGAL BEFORE 1756 SUCCESSOR STATE AND SOVEREIGNTY CONFLICT WEALTHY MUGHAL SUCCESSOR STATE, NOT A POLITICAL VACUUM 1717 FARMAN BOUNDED PRIVILEGE FOR COMPANY TRADE DASTAK ABUSE SERVANTS' PRIVATE TRADE FORTIFICATION + CUSTOMS + JURISDICTION

BENGAL → wealthy Mughal successor state, not a political vacuum

1717 FARMAN → bounded privilege for Company trade

DASTAK ABUSE → servants' private trade

FORTIFICATION + customs + jurisdiction → commercial dispute becomes sovereignty dispute

CORE CLAIM

- BENGAL → wealthy Mughal successor state, not a political vacuum
- 1717 FARMAN → bounded privilege for Company trade
- DASTAK ABUSE → servants' private trade

MECHANISM

- FORTIFICATION + customs + jurisdiction → commercial dispute becomes sovereignty dispute
- SIRAJ 1756 → inherits court rivalry and a Company testing Nawabi authority.
- MUST REMEMBER: Plassey on 23 June 1757, Buxar on 22 October 1764, the 1765

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Allahabad settlement and Diwani grant, and the 1765-72 Dual Government are separate stages.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Plassey on 23 June 1757, Buxar on 22 October 1764, the 1765 Allahabad settlement and Diwani grant, and the 1765-72 Dual Government are separate stages.

01

STAGE 01 CALCUTTA CRISIS AND THE BLACK HOLE CAUTION

CALCUTTA CRISIS AND THE BLACK HOLE CAUTION UNAUTHORISED FORTIFICATION KASIMBAZAR SEIZED FORT WILLIAM FALLS IN JUNE 1756 CALCUTTA RECOVERED CHANDERNAGORE REMOVED AS COUNTERWEIGHT BLACK HOLE HOLWELL IS AN INTERESTED, WEAKLY CORROBORATED NARRATOR

UNAUTHORISED FORTIFICATION → Kasimbazar seized → Fort William falls in June 1756

CLIVE / WATSON → Calcutta recovered → Alinagar → Chandernagore removed as counterweight

BLACK HOLE → Holwell is an interested, weakly corroborated narrator

RULE → never make a disputed body count or atrocity story the causal centre of

CORE CLAIM

- UNAUTHORISED FORTIFICATION → Kasimbazar seized → Fort William falls in June 1756
- CLIVE / WATSON → Calcutta recovered → Alinagar → Chandernagore removed as counterweight

MECHANISM

- BLACK HOLE → Holwell is an interested, weakly corroborated narrator
- RULE → never make a disputed body count or atrocity story the causal centre of conquest.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- UNAUTHORISED FORTIFICATION → Kasimbazar seized → Fort William falls in June 1756
- CLIVE / WATSON → Calcutta recovered → Alinagar → Chandernagore removed as counterweight

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → never make a disputed body count or atrocity story the causal centre of conquest.

02

STAGE 02 PLASSEY'S HIDDEN BATTLE: CONSPIRACY AND COLLABORATION

PLASSEY'S HIDDEN BATTLE CONSPIRACY AND COLLABORATION REGIME-CHANGE PLAN + SECRET CORRESPONDENCE + COERCIVE LEVERAGE MIR JAFAR JAGAT SETH CREDIT AND SECURITY RAI DURLABH BROKER LATER DECEIVED

COMPANY / CLIVE → regime-change plan + secret correspondence + coercive leverage

MIR JAFAR → throne

JAGAT SETH → credit and security

RAI DURLABH → office

CORE CLAIM

- COMPANY / CLIVE → regime-change plan + secret correspondence + coercive leverage
- MIR JAFAR → throne
- JAGAT SETH → credit and security

MECHANISM

- RAI DURLABH → office
- AMICHAND → broker later deceived
- MIR MADAN / MOHAN LAL → loyal resistance

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT → interests explain collaboration better than a one-word betrayal morality tale.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → interests explain collaboration better than a one-word betrayal morality tale.

03

STAGE 03 PLASSEY AND THE MIR JAFAR CLIENT REGIME

- VERDICT → interests explain collaboration better than a one-word betrayal morality tale.

03

PLASSEY CHANGED THE RULER; IT DID NOT YET GRANT

- PLASSEY, 23 JUNE 1757 → conspiracy neutralises most Nawabi command
- RESULT → Mir Jafar installed; Company becomes kingmaker and gains political entry

04

ABOLISH INLAND DUTIES FOR ALL TRADERS

COMPANY RESISTS LOST ADVANTAGE → war → Mir Qasim seeks an Awadh-Mughal coalition.

- MIR QASIM 1760 → shifts capital to Munger + strengthens administration and army
- COMPANY PRIVATE TRADE → duty privilege distorts competition and weakens Nawabi revenue

05

HECTOR MUNRO'S INTEGRATED COMMAND, SUPPLY AND PAYMENT SYSTEM

OPEN MILITARY SUPREMACY, UNLIKE PLASSEY'S PALACE COUP.

STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS → separate treasuries, commands and political objectives

- **COALITION** → Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daula + Shah Alam II; distinct motives
- **STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS** → separate treasuries, commands and political objectives

06

DIWANI 1765

→ **RULE → Plassey alone did not complete Company sovereignty over Bengal.**

- PLASSEY 1757 → POLITICAL ENTRY: client Nawab and Company kingmaking
- BUXAR 1764 → MILITARY SUPREMACY: Bengal-Awadh-emperor coalition defeated

06

STAGE 06 THREE-STAGE CONQUEST THESIS

THREE-STAGE CONQUEST THESIS

PLASSEY 1757

POLITICAL ENTRY

CLIENT NAWAB AND COMPANY KINGMAKING

BUXAR 1764

MILITARY SUPREMACY

BENGAL-AWADH-EMPEROR COALITION DEFEATED

DIWANI 1765

PLASSEY 1757 → POLITICAL ENTRY: client Nawab and Company kingmaking

BUXAR 1764 → MILITARY SUPREMACY: Bengal-Awadh-emperor coalition defeated

→ ALLAHABAD / DIWANI 1765 → LEGAL-FISCAL TITLE: revenue authority institutionalised

→ RULE → Plassey alone did not complete Company sovereignty over Bengal.

CORE CLAIM

- PLASSEY 1757 → POLITICAL ENTRY: client Nawab and Company kingmaking
- BUXAR 1764 → MILITARY SUPREMACY: Bengal-Awadh-emperor coalition defeated

MECHANISM

- ALLAHABAD / DIWANI 1765 → LEGAL-FISCAL TITLE: revenue authority institutionalised
- RULE → Plassey alone did not complete Company sovereignty over Bengal.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PLASSEY 1757 → POLITICAL ENTRY: client Nawab and Company kingmaking
- BUXAR 1764 → MILITARY SUPREMACY: Bengal-Awadh-emperor coalition defeated

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → Plassey alone did not complete Company sovereignty over Bengal.

07

STAGE 07 ALLAHABAD, DIWANI, NIZAMAT AND THE AWADH BUFFER

ALLAHABAD, DIWANI, NIZAMAT AND THE AWADH BUFFER

SHAH ALAM II SETTLEMENT

COMPANY RECEIVES DIWANI OF BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA

SHUJA-UD-DAULA SETTLEMENT

AWADH RESTORED AS A STRATEGIC BUFFER, NOT ANNEXED

CIVIL SIDE

NOMINAL POLICE, CRIMINAL AND MILITARY SIDE

DIWANI WAS NOT NAWABSHIP AND THE LEGAL SPLIT WAS

SHAH ALAM II SETTLEMENT → Company receives Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa

SHUJA-UD-DAULA SETTLEMENT → Awadh restored as a strategic buffer, not annexed

→ DIWANI → revenue / civil side

→ NIZAMAT → nominal police, criminal and military side

CORE CLAIM

- SHAH ALAM II SETTLEMENT → Company receives Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa
- SHUJA-UD-DAULA SETTLEMENT → Awadh restored as a strategic buffer, not annexed

MECHANISM

- DIWANI → revenue / civil side
- NIZAMAT → nominal police, criminal and military side

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CAUTION → Diwani was not Nawabship and the legal split was not equal power-sharing.
- SHAH ALAM II SETTLEMENT → Company receives Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → Diwani was not Nawabship and the legal split was not equal power-sharing.

08

STAGE 08 DUAL GOVERNMENT: POWER SEPARATED FROM RESPONSIBILITY

DUAL GOVERNMENT

POWER SEPARATED FROM RESPONSIBILITY

COMPANY HOLDS REVENUE POWER THROUGH INDIAN DEPUTIES

NAWAB'S ESTABLISHMENT

NOMINAL NIZAMAT AND PUBLIC RESPONSIBILITY WITHOUT RESOURCES

COMPANY POWER WITHOUT RESPONSIBILITY

NAWAB RESPONSIBILITY WITHOUT POWER

EXTRACTION INCENTIVES + DIFFUSED ACCOUNTABILITY + WEAK CORRECTIVE CAPACITY.

CORE CLAIM

- 1765-72 → Company holds revenue power through Indian deputies
- NAWAB'S ESTABLISHMENT → nominal Nizamat and public responsibility without resources

MECHANISM

- PARADOX → Company power without responsibility / Nawab responsibility without power
- RESULT → extraction incentives + diffused accountability + weak corrective capacity.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 1765-72 → Company holds revenue power through Indian deputies
- NAWAB'S ESTABLISHMENT → nominal Nizamat and public responsibility without resources

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → extraction incentives + diffused accountability + weak corrective capacity.

09

STAGE 09 FAMINE, ACCOUNTABILITY AND THE 1772 TERMINATION

FAMINE, ACCOUNTABILITY AND THE 1772 TERMINATION

1770 FAMINE

HARVEST FAILURE

DROUGHT AND DISEASE CREATE THE NATURAL SHOCK

DUAL GOVERNMENT

REVENUE RIGIDITY AND ADMINISTRATIVE CONFUSION AMPLIFY VULNERABILITY

COMPANY POLICY MATTERED BUT DID NOT ALONE CAUSE DROUGHT

HASTINGS 1772

1770 FAMINE → harvest failure / drought and disease create the natural shock

→ DUAL GOVERNMENT → revenue rigidity and administrative confusion amplify vulnerability

→ CAUTION → Company policy mattered but did not alone cause drought or the catastrophe

→ HASTINGS 1772 → ends Dual Government; direct administration bridges to Topic 06.

→ CLOSE DISTINCTION: Plassey enabled political leverage through conspiracy and finance

CORE CLAIM

- 1770 FAMINE → harvest failure / drought and disease create the natural shock
- DUAL GOVERNMENT → revenue rigidity and administrative confusion amplify vulnerability
- CAUTION → Company policy mattered but did not alone cause drought or the catastrophe

MECHANISM

- HASTINGS 1772 → ends Dual Government; direct administration bridges to Topic 06.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Plassey enabled political leverage through conspiracy and finance
- Buxar established a broader military-fiscal superiority against Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula and Shah

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Alam II.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Plassey enabled political leverage through conspiracy and finance; Buxar established a broader military-fiscal superiority against Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula and Shah.

natural shock

confusion amplify vulnerability

drought or the catastrophe

bridges to Topic 06.

conspiracy and finance

CORE CLAIM

- 1770 FAMINE → harvest failure / drought and disease create the natural shock
- DUAL GOVERNMENT → revenue rigidity and administrative confusion amplify vulnerability
- CAUTION → Company policy mattered but did not alone cause drought or the catastrophe

MECHANISM

- HASTINGS 1772 → ends Dual Government; direct administration bridges to Topic 06.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Plassey enabled political leverage through conspiracy and finance
- Buxar established a broader military-fiscal superiority against Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula and Shah

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Alam II.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Plassey enabled political leverage through conspiracy and finance; Buxar established a broader military-fiscal superiority against Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula and Shah.

10

STAGE 10

COMPANY-STATE, EARLY DRAIN MECHANISM AND HISTORIOGRAPHY

COMPANY-STATE, EARLY DRAIN MECHANISM AND HISTORIOGRAPHY

TRADE PRIVILEGE

REVENUE FUNDS PURCHASES AND ARMIES

INDIAN AGENCY

COLLABORATION, RESISTANCE AND ADMINISTRATION OPERATE UNDER UNEQUAL POWER

NATIONALIST EXTRACTION

CORPORATE-FISCAL STATE

BENGAL CONTINUITY

INDIAN AGENCY → collaboration, resistance and administration operate under unequal power

TRADE PRIVILEGE → kingmaking → Diwani → revenue funds purchases and armies

LENSES → nationalist extraction

corporate-fiscal state

CORE CLAIM

- TRADE PRIVILEGE → kingmaking → Diwani → revenue funds purchases and armies
- INDIAN AGENCY → collaboration, resistance and administration operate under unequal power
- LENSES → nationalist extraction

MECHANISM

- corporate-fiscal state
- Bengal continuity
- 2026 MEMORY ANCHOR → revisit Plassey beyond betrayal; static causation remains book-grounded.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Company records and later nationalist accounts must be checked against Bengal court, banking and revenue evidence
- conquest was contingent, collaborative and coercive.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Company records and later nationalist accounts must be checked against Bengal court, banking and revenue evidence; conquest was contingent, collaborative and coercive.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 04 ANSWER SPINE AND BOUNDARIES

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SOVEREIGNTY CONFLICT OVER PRIVILEGE, PRIVATE TRADE, FORTIFICATION AND JURISDICTION

CLIENT REGIME

REFORM AND WAR

DUAL GOVERNMENT

COLLABORATION + COMPANY CAPACITY; FAMINE IS MULTICAUSAL; REJECT FALSE

1772 ENDS THIS TOPIC; EXPANSION AND 1773+ REGULATION PASS

OPEN → sovereignty conflict over privilege, private trade, fortification and jurisdiction

TRACE → conspiracy / client regime → reform and war → Buxar → Diwani →

WEIGH → collaboration + Company capacity; famine is multicausal; reject false precision

CLOSE → 1772 ends this topic; expansion and 1773+ regulation pass to Topics 05-06.

CORE CLAIM

- OPEN → sovereignty conflict over privilege, private trade, fortification and jurisdiction
- TRACE → conspiracy / client regime → reform and war → Buxar → Diwani → Dual Government

MECHANISM

- WEIGH → collaboration + Company capacity; famine is multicausal; reject false precision
- CLOSE → 1772 ends this topic; expansion and 1773+ regulation pass to Topics 05-06.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- OPEN → sovereignty conflict over privilege, private trade, fortification and jurisdiction
- TRACE → conspiracy / client regime → reform and war → Buxar → Diwani → Dual Government

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → 1772 ends this topic; expansion and 1773+ regulation pass to Topics 05-06.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE COMPANY USED THE 1717 FARMAN AND DASTAKS TO

BEYOND LEGITIMATE COMPANY GOODS, DAMAGING THE NAWAB'S REVENUE AND

COMPANY SERVANTS PURSUED PRIVATE TRADE UNDER THE COVER OF

CREATING A CONFLICT BETWEEN BENGAL'S FISCAL SOVEREIGNTY AND COMPANY

FORTIFICATION OF CALCUTTA WITHOUT NAWAB PERMISSION CHALLENGED SIRAJ-UD-DAULA'S AUTHORITY

THE BLACK HOLE NARRATIVE SHOULD BE TREATED CAUTIOUSLY BECAUSE

PLASSEY WAS A PALACE-AND-BANKING CONSPIRACY INVOLVING MIR JAFAR, RAI

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- The Company used the 1717 farman and dastaks to expand duty-free trade
- beyond legitimate Company goods, damaging the Nawab's revenue and Indian merchants.
- Company servants pursued private trade under the cover of Company privileges,
- creating a conflict between Bengal's fiscal sovereignty and Company commercial immunity.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- Fortification of Calcutta without Nawab permission challenged Siraj-ud-Daula's authority and made the Company appear like a political power.
- CAUTION: The Black Hole narrative should be treated cautiously because its details and later use as imperial justification are contested.
- Plassey was a palace-and-banking conspiracy involving Mir Jafar, Rai Durlabh, Jagat Seth and Amichand
- it gave the Company a pliant Nawab and enormous leverage.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Mir Qasim tried to restore autonomy through administrative reform, military reorganisation and abolition of inland duties
- this threatened Company privilege.
- Buxar mattered more militarily because the Company defeated a combined Bengal-Awadh-Mughal force, proving supremacy beyond palace politics.
- Allahabad (1765) gave the Company Diwani while keeping Awadh as a buffer, producing a revenue-backed territorial corporation.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.